1495 UNIVERSITY OF ABERDEEN

CELEBRATING 525 YEARS 1495 – 2020

ABERDEEN 2040

JB2001 – Marketing Assessment Brief (26/27)

2627

Task:

Produce a group report analysing the competitive positioning of two rival brands in the same industry. Evaluate their marketing strategies and customer engagement. Provide recommendations on how one brand could improve its competitive advantage.

Submission Deadline: 13/11/2026 ☺

Assessment Criteria	The level descriptor for the assessment criteria				
	Below - E1	**D3 – D1**	**C3 – C1**	**B3– B1**	**A5 – A1**
Executive summary [5%]	Absent or irrelevant.	Minimal or unclear.	Basic, descriptive overview. Lacks critical focus.	Adequate summary, though it may be descriptive or lack some precision.	Exceptionally clear, concise, and engaging. Demonstrates sophisticated understanding of the brief.
Theoretical framework and literature use [25%]	No meaningful use of theory. Sources absent, irrelevant, or plagiarised.	Inadequate engagement with theory. Very limited or inappropriate sources.	Limited engagement with theory; reliance on textbook sources. Missing key debates or critical discussions.	Sound use of relevant theories. Some gaps in coverage or integration of the literature. Reliance on a narrower set of sources.	Comprehensive, innovative use of relevant theories; a wide range of up-to-date academic sources integrated seamlessly. Original insight into theoretical debates.
Application to case organisation [30%]	No precise application; irrelevant or inaccurate examples.	Weak, limited, or poorly chosen application of theory. The evidence is anecdotal or inaccurate.	Application is present but often weak, descriptive, or partially inaccurate.	Good application with some clear examples, but occasionally superficial or inconsistent.	Outstanding application of theory to chosen case; highly relevant, accurate, and creative use of examples and data.
Critical evaluation [30%]	No evaluation; recommendations missing, incoherent, or unrelated to evidence.	Very little evaluation: work is primarily descriptive. Recommendations lack feasibility or justification.	Some evaluation was attempted, but it was primarily descriptive. Recommendations are simplistic or weakly linked to theory.	Evidence of evaluation, but limited depth. Recommendations are relevant but may lack full justification or creativity.	Critical thinking is sophisticated and original. Recommendations are practical, innovative, and fully justified by evidence and theory.
Presentation and referencing [10%]	Disorganised structure, very poor or no referencing.	Poor structure and coherence. Frequent referencing errors.	Acceptable structure, but inconsistencies in flow. Referencing is incomplete or inaccurate.	Good report structure, though some formatting and referencing errors.	Professional-level report structure, flawless formatting, and Harvard referencing without error.

General Instructions

Word Count: 2,000 words. This excludes the Cover page, Table of Contents, References and Appendices. Word count should not be exceeded (an allowance of +/ - 10% of the stated value is allowed).
Cover page: The title, names of individual members, student ID, and word count must be included.
Format: Times New Roman 12pt. The line spacing should be 1.5, and the paragraphs should be justified.
Figures & Tables: All figures and tables should be numbered and clearly described. If you include statistical data or images, these must also be correctly referenced, and these sources, together with any academic or reported material, must be included in a reference section attached to your report.
Referencing: You should, where appropriate, refer to academic journal articles or examples derived from contemporary marketing practice where insight may support your analysis. You must provide at least 10 scholarly references. All sources on the reference list must be cited in-text. The Harvard system (APA 7th edition) should be used for all submissions. For guidance on use, please see Referencing and citing— *Referencing for Business Students*.
Appendices: Appendices can be used to provide additional supporting material [must not exceed two pages], although it is not required.

AVOID LATE SUBMISSIONS!

Please note that 1 second late is late, and late penalties will be rigorously applied to any submission received after the deadline. Late submissions will be penalised per the University's Regulations and Guidelines.

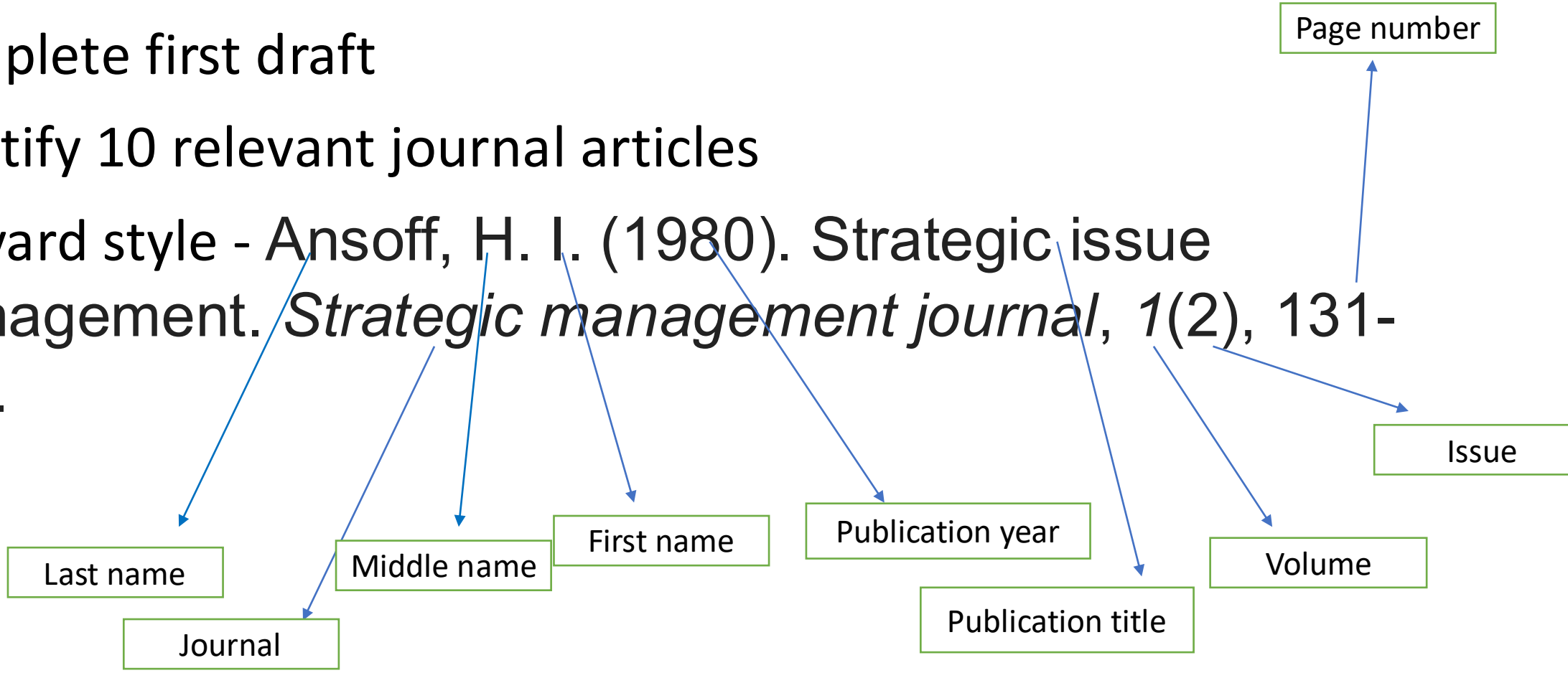
Always retain an electronic copy of your assignment!!!!!

Report structure

- Cover page
  - Report title
  - Students' names and ID numbers
  - Word count
- Executive summary
- Table of contents
- Introduction – e.g., background, company history
- Main body
  - Think about content, logic and structure.
  - Think about theories, analysis, application, and evaluation.
- Recommendations – e.g., proposition for future research or practical application
- Conclusions
- References (min 10 academic sources)
  - APA intext e.g., (Ansoff, 1980)
  - APA reference list e.g., Ansoff, H. I. (1980). Strategic issue management. *Strategic management journal*, *1*(2), 131-148.
- Appendix (Not required – max two pages, must be cross referenced appropriately)

Referencing

- Complete first draft
- Identify 10 relevant journal articles
- Harvard style - Ansoff, H. I. (1980). Strategic issue management. *Strategic management journal*, *1*(2), 131-148.



Key Elements

- Knowledge [e.g., Fishbein-Ajzen Model, 1980, 4Ps/7Ps]
- Application [e.g., Starbucks, Luckin Coffee]
- Analysis [critical thinking e.g., criticisms, pros/cons, impact, implications, consequences, effect]
- Evaluation [judgement e.g., overall extent of impact]

Writing up: Style and flow

Use of appropriate English, paragraphs, and linkage sentences? Is the report structured and organised to aid comprehension? See next slide for transitional statements

Advice

- Have fluent and logical linkages between slides
- Have a clear structure
- Use headings to make the structure clear

Transitional statements

To Add to an Idea	To Compare Points	To Prove a Theory	To Show Exception	To Give an Example	To Show Sequence
And	However	Because	Nevertheless	For example	First
Furthermore	In contrast	In any case	However	For instance	Second
Besides	Although	Moreover	In spite of	To illustrate	Third
Finally	Nevertheless	Evidently	Sometimes	To demonstrate	Fourth, etc.
In addition	Meanwhile	Obviously	Of course	In this situation	Then
Again	By comparison	Indeed	Yet	Take the case of	Next
Equally important	On the contrary	Since	Once in a while	On this occasion	When that is done
Note: Do not use "firstly", "secondly," etc.					

Taken from Google.com

Writing up: Critical problems

To what extent do you clearly state the key problems/challenges/issues in the selected model/concept?

Advice

- Ensure you justify the rationale for your analysis.

Writing up: Models and Concepts

What can you tell the reader about the model? Strength? Weaknesses? What has worked in practice and what hasn't? Has the model evolved? What has changed since the conceptualisation of the model/concept?

Do you integrate existing information from academic papers and propose your thoughts through sound logical reasoning?

Advice

- Apply models/frameworks/concepts comprehensively
- Generate insights when applying each model
- Use practical examples to support analysis
- Provide evidence and rationale

Writing up: Recommendations

Considering the Strength? Weaknesses? What has worked in practice and what hasn't? What do you propose?

Advice

- Recommendations should be appropriate, relevant and practical to address key problems.
- Avoid being descriptive
- Be critical (see points above)
- Synthesise the existing literature and propose your own thoughts
- Paraphrase thoughts and avoid copying and pasting (this could lead to plagiarism)

Writing up: Referencing

Do you have up to 10 good quality, academic and relevant sources? Are the references cited appropriately and consistently throughout?

Advice

- Cite a minimum of 10 high-quality academic sources - including textbooks, journal articles, reports, websites
- Sources must be credible (see the last page for websites to avoid)
- Demonstrate good evidence of wide reading and research
- Ensure your references/citations are complete with every borrowed idea properly acknowledged
- Use consistent citation format throughout (e.g. Harvard – see bb for more info on referencing styles)

Websites to avoid….

- Businessballs
- Tutor2u
- Net MBA
- Yourdictionary
- Business dictionary
- Suite 101
- answers.com
- changeingminds.org
- change-management-coach
- hroot.com
- brightub.com
- smallbusiness.chron.com
- leadership-with-you
- scholarworks
- psychology.com
- businesscasestudies.co.uk
- stabusiness.pbworks.com
- businessmate.org
- mindtools.com
- tutorialspoint.com
- ukessays.com
- blogspot.com
- fao.org
- cliffsnotes.com

Thank YOU!